Neglect Not Thy Gift / Spiritual Gifts

Teaching notes and student handouts adapted from existing spiritual-gifts course materials; source acknowledgments retained.

Full teaching files

GIFTS SERIES INTO STUDENT COPY	*3 pages*
GIFTS SERIES INTRO TEACHER COPY	*3 pages*
WEEK 1 GIFTS EVANGELIST, TEACHER, PASTOR STUDENTS COPY	*2 pages*
WEEK 1 GIFTS EVANGELIST, TEACHER, PASTOR TEACHERS COPY	*3 pages*
WEEK 2 GIVING, RULING, SHEWING MERCY STUDENT COPY	*2 pages*
WEEK 2 GIVING, RULING, SHEWING MERCY TEACHER COPY	*4 pages*
WEEK 3 ministering, exhorting STUDENT COPY	*2 pages*
WEEK 3 ministering, exhorting TEACHER COPY	*3 pages*
WEEK 5 WORD OF WISDOM, WORD OF KNOWLEDGE, SINGLENESS STUDENT COPY	*2 pages*
WEEK 5 WORD OF WISDOM, WORD OF KNOWLEDGE, SINGLENESS TEACHER COPY	*4 pages*
WEEK 5 STUDENT COPY, DISCERNING SPIRITS, HELPS, GOVERNMENTS	*2 pages*
WEEK 5 TEACHER COPY, DISCERNING SPIRITS, HELPS, GOVERNMENTS	*4 pages*
WEEK 6 STUDENT COPY FAITH, PROPHESY, AND OUTRO	*3 pages*
WEEK 6 TEACHER COPY FAITH, PROPHESY, AND OUTRO	*4 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.



Wednesday, April 27th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- 1 COR. 12:1-7, 11-31

I. It is of utmost importance that each and every believer realizes their importance in the grand plan of God. There is a plan that involves eternity, souls, the great battle between good and evil (God and the Devil), and the future kingdoms of the world; and God has made it so that he needs each and every one of us to be involved in this plan. God saw you as so valuable that he gave his own life for you. The value he sees in you does not stop there, but continues into the plan God has for each and every one of us in this grand plan of his. Knowing your _____in this fight and what role God MADE YOU TO PLAY is necessary in order to be successful for the Lord. Over the course of the coming weeks we are going to look at these gifts and each and every one of us that are a part of the family of God will see how great a role we play in this _____ _____, and exactly what God made you to do in it.

II. DON'T BE IGNORANT ABOUT SPIRITUAL GIFTS (vs. 1)

A. This issue is of such importance! This can help us find our place in the body of Christ and give us a purpose.

1. Prov. 16:3- "Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established.
2. "Spiritual Gifts vs. Natural Gifts

a) Natural Gifts- We are all made by God a certain way and with certain gifts. Some of these gifts could be artists, musicians, speakers, influencers, leaders, servants, athletes, etc…These are not "spiritual gifts" but gifts that we are born with that we can use to serve the Lord. Some of these gifts cross over into our spiritual gifts when we become a part of the body of Christ at salvation. (if you are a good speakers naturally, you likely will have the spiritual gift of teacher/evangelist; and so on with other gifts)

b) Spiritual Gifts- When we have the spirit of God move into us at the moment of salvation, we are given some spiritual gifts that we need to find out what they are. These gifts may come to us as a result of how we are naturally gifted, but may not always. We are able to desire and ask for and be given (develop) new spiritual gifts. This is a unique thing about spiritual gifts that is not the case with our natural gifts. (1 Cor. 14:1; 1 Cor. 14:12)

(1) As we go through this series, analyze what your spiritual gifts are and maybe how they relate to your natural gifts. And also, don't be upset about the gifts you don't have, but desire spiritual gifts that you want to develop and ask God for them. These spiritual gifts will be the gifts that our series is focused on.

III. THE SAME SPIRIT WORKETH IN US ALL (vs. 2-7)

A. We all will have different gifts and ways that come easier for us to serve the Lord, we need to not be jealous/envious over others and rather understand our gifts and help others with our gifts

1. 1 Cor. 14:12- "Even so ye, forasmuch as ye are zealous of spiritual gifts, seek that ye may **excel to the edifying of the church**."

a) We can seek to find/have spiritual gifts, but for the purpose of serving God and _____others where they may lack in these gifts. NOT FOR OURSELVES.
b) KEY: WE CANNOT SEE THIS ISSUE WITH PRIDE AND NOT WITH CHARITY. We have to be honest and own the gifts that God has given us, but we cannot let it become about us. It is not prideful to say you have certain gifts since it is important we recognize our gifts, but we must give God the credit and glory with them.
(1) 1 Cor. 1:26-31- "For ye see your calling, brethren, how that not many wise men after the flesh, not many mighty, not many noble, *are called*: But God hath chosen the foolish things of the world to confound the wise; and God hath chosen the weak things of the world to confound the things which are mighty; And base things of the world, and things which are despised, hath God chosen, *yea*, and things which are not, to bring to nought things that are: That no flesh should glory in his presence. But of him are ye in Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption: **That, according as it is written, He that glorieth, let him glory in the Lord."**

IV. THE BODY OF CHRIST (vs. 11-31)

A. We are all a part of the body of Christ (vs. 11-20)
1. Like in our bodies, all of our parts contribute to the whole of us. The sum of all of our parts is called our body.
2. Each of us has a role in the body (just as each part of our bodies has a role). This role is greatly influenced by our spiritual gifts. We are made by God to have a specific function in the church. We are not just some random part of the body, we are _____ by God for a purpose
a) Jer. 1:5- "Before I formed thee in the belly I knew thee; and before thou camest forth out of the womb I sanctified thee, *and* I ordained thee a prophet unto the nations."
b) Psalm 139:13-14- "For thou hast possessed my reins: thou hast covered me in my mother's womb. I will praise thee; for I am fearfully *and* wonderfully made: marvellous *are* thy works; and *that* my soul knoweth right well."

B. The seemingly most insignificant, are the most significant with God (vs. 21-31)
1. Think of some of the smallest parts of the body. They may seem insignificant at first glance, but they are essential in order to function best and even survive
2. No role in the body of Christ is insignificant. We often look at the pastors, teachers, or people who know a lot about the bible and think of them as extra spiritual. THIS IS WRONG THINKING AND CAN ONLY CAUSE ISSUES IN THE BODY. We need to understand that the groups of people that do the things that are not out in the open are just as important as the other parts of the body.
a) If I asked you what the heart or brain were and what they do, all of us know. However, as we just saw, the parts of the body you may never have even heard of are just as essential to survival.
b) It is also good to know that while the body can survive without certain parts, or with injured parts; it _____function at full capacity and may be severely

maimed. THIS IS WHY IT IS OF UTMOST IMPORTANCE THAT WE ALL KNOW OUR GIFTS/ROLES AND USE THEM AS GOD MADE US TO DO. WE ARE ALL NEEDED AS A PART OF THE BODY!!!

V. As we begin our journey looking at spiritual gifts, we must realize the importance God has placed on this subject in his word. Many people don't want any part of the Christian life because they see it as boring and uninteresting. This could not be further from the truth.When you understand your place in the body of Christ and the ways God has gifted you to serve him, you will feel like you are doing what you were made to do (because you quite literally are), and your life will be _____and joyful! It will come with persecution and hard times, but you will have a purpose and a reason for living. As we go through gifts, we will all evaluate how God has gifted us and we will use these gifts to better serve the Lord and one another.

1 Cor. 14:12- "Even so ye, forasmuch as ye are zealous of spiritual *gifts*, seek that ye may excel to the edifying of the church."



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II. DON'T BE IGNORANT ABOUT SPIRITUAL GIFTS (vs. 1)

A. This issue is of such importance! This can help us find our place in the body of Christ and give us a purpose.

B. So many people won't serve or commit to God once they are saved because they think it's boring. BUT once you find your place in the body and you find your gifts, you will love the work of the Lord and this will in turn establish your correct thinking, time in the Bible, prayer life, etc….

1. Prov. 16:3- "Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established."

C. TELL MY TESTIMONY ABOUT EVANGELISM, GIFTS, AND THE VERSE ABOVE

D. Spiritual Gifts vs. Natural Gifts

1. This issue is another part of the spiritual gifts that we cannot be ignorant about.
2. Natural Gifts- We are all made by God a certain way and with certain gifts. Some of these gifts could be artists, musicians, speakers, influencers, leaders, servants, athletes, etc…These are not "spiritual gifts" but gifts that we are born with that we can use to serve the Lord. Some of these gifts cross over into our spiritual gifts when we become a part of the body of Christ at salvation. (if you are a good speakers naturally, you likely will have the spiritual gift of teacher/evangelist; and so on with other gifts)
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(1) When you begin to look at people how God sees them, and you really understand that God MADE and FORMED specifically each and every person that was born, you will not be a respecter of persons and you will see that everyone is essential in God's grand plan for the universe!

B. The seemingly most insignificant, are the most significant with God (vs. 21-31)

1. Think of some of the smallest parts of the body. They may seem insignificant at first glance, but they are essential in order to function best and even survive

a) The eye and the fingers (specifically the thumb). The smallest bone in the body is the Stapes and it is essential to hearing. When fractured it causes severe hearing

loss and most commonly will cause deafness. The smallest organ in the body is the Pineal gland located in the center of the brain. When damaged, it becomes almost impossible to sleep or to have a sense of direction. Finally, we can look at the cell. The cells of our bodies, which are the foundation for life, are so intricate and necessary, we cannot live without cells or without healthy functioning cells. Cells that are not healthy, when they multiply, are what we call cancer.

2. No role in the body of Christ is insignificant. We often look at the pastors, teachers, or people who know a lot about the bible and think of them as extra spiritual. THIS IS WRONG THINKING AND CAN ONLY CAUSE ISSUES IN THE BODY. We need to understand that the groups of people that do the things that are not out in the open are just as important as the other parts of the body.
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Wednesday, May 11th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- EPHESIANS 4:11-12

I. Today we will be looking at the 3 gifts found in Ephesians chapter 4: **evangelist, pastor, and teacher**. These gifts are some of the gifts that are seen by some as "more important" because they are done more publicly. Again, as we looked at and talked about last week, that is not how gifts work. In fact, with these gifts being more public by nature, they come with a greater _____. They can come with the burden of responsibility for teaching others, pastoring well, and the burden of the eternal destination of souls. When they are not carried out properly many souls can suffer for all of eternity. This is why we must recognize and _____the gifts God has given us, no matter what they may be.

II. Ephesians 4:11-12

A. _____

1. The word evangelist shows up only 3x in the bible
   a) Acts 21:8; 2 Tim. 4:5
2. Philip is called "Philip the Evangelist". He is the only one called an evangelist in the Bible.
   a) Marks of an evangelist as shown by "the evangelist" **(Acts 8:4-40**)
      (1) Meeting people where they are at (vs. 5)
      (2) They are good and persuasive at sharing the gospel (vs. 6-13)
      (3) They can sometimes focus so much on the gospel, that they have a hard time with follow up/discipleship (vs. 14)
      (4) They have an ability to see who/when/where to share the gospel successfully and effectively (vs.26-29)
      (5) They have an ability to ask the right questions, preach the gospel creatively, and lead people to the Lord because of it (vs. 30-40)
3. If you feel that this may be a gift you have, you are responsible to use it. This means if you slip and get lazy or fall away, you will have the most blood on your hands (Eze. 33:1-6).

B. _____

1. A pastor in the Bible is someone who is responsible for the shepherding and care of a flock of people. (*pastor="pasture" or "shepherding")* It is an ordained office in the structure of the local church as we find in the pastoral epistles (specifically 1 Timothy and Titus).
   a) The words Elder, Bishop, and Pastor are all used interchangeably in the Bible talking about the official position of a pastor in a church.

2. The gift of pastoring and the call to be a pastor do not necessarily go directly hand in hand.
    a) Some have the gift of pastoring, the heart of a pastor, and they will never be in an official, full time, vocational ministry position as they don't feel that call.
3. Responsibilities of those who have this gift
    a) 1 Pet. 5:1-4; John 10:11-14
        (1) Those who have this gift, have such a heart for the church of God and of caring for the "sheep" of God, that they are consumed with the care of the sheep at all times.
4. Examples of people who were gifted with the heart of a pastor
    a) Jesus Christ
        (1) Luke 13:34-35; Matt. 18:10-14; Heb. 13:20
    b) David
        (1) Eze. 34:23; Ezek. 37:24; Psalm 23:1; 1 Sam. 17:34-36

C. _____

1. A teacher is someone who is able to communicate information in an effective way so as to inform and "teach" others about the Bible in a very practical way.
2. Different ways that someone with the gift of a teacher can teach
    a) **Publically**- Someone who is a gifted teacher is able to teach the Bible publically in an effective and clear way. They may experience less fear of public speaking than some, but will most likely experience the fear of public speaking to some extent regardless. (this gift does not necessarily mean that you won't be bothered by public speaking but that you will be able to do it regardless by the gift God gave you)
    b) **Individually**- Someone who is a gifted teacher is able to teach the Bible privately in an effective and clear way. They are engaging and practical in how they teach the Bible to their disciples, friends, co-workers, family, etc… on a personal and private basis.
3. Examples of biblical teachers both private and public
    a) Apollos and Aquila and Priscilla - Acts 18:24-28
    b) Paul- 1 Tim. 2:7
    c) Aaron (Exo. 4:14)

III. As we saw in the first 3 gifts today, there is so much that the Bible has to say about each of these gifts. They are all very important within the body of Christ and they are all important to God. These gifts are all more publicly seen, but no more important than the gifts we will look at in the coming weeks. If anything, they just come with a greater burden of responsibility and can be detrimental to the body if they are not used correctly.



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II. Ephesians 4:11-12

A. Evangelist

1. The word evangelist shows up only 3x in the bible
   a) Acts 21:8; 2 Tim. 4:5
2. Philip is called "Philip the Evangelist". He is the only one called an evangelist in the Bible.
   a) Marks of an evangelist as shown by "the evangelist" (**Acts 8:4-40**)
      (1) **Meeting people where they are at (vs. 5**)
         (a) At this time many still struggled with preaching and teaching to gentiles, but Philip was right away "going down" to Samaria to preach. Evangelists will share the gospel with anyone that will listen. They have such a burden for souls to hear the gospel.
      (2) **They are good and persuasive at sharing the gospel (vs. 6-13)**
         (a) For evangelists, sharing the gospel is easy, they enjoy it, and they do it well. They are able to persuade and lead others to Christ. They are able and responsible to help those who struggle to evangelize to be better at it and to encourage others.
         (b) It is interesting that Philip could do miracles, and yet he was known for his evangelism and his preaching was what persuaded them.
         (c) This is another reason why we know that some of the old gifts (tongues, healings, interpretation of tongues, apostleship, etc… are not used anymore, the gifts that remain are GREATER and more useful for the majority gentile world. Signs are for the Jews.
      (3) **They can sometimes focus so much on the gospel, that they have a hard time with follow up/discipleship (vs. 14)**
         (a) Here we see that when the disciples heard about the souls being saved in Samaria, they sent Peter and John down to help establish the new believers. When they arrive, we find the new converts are still needing straightened out on some basic things. Peter and John take care of this, with no mention of Philip being involved.
      (4) **They have an ability to see who/when/where to share the gospel successfully and effectively (vs.26-29)**

(a) Here Philip is called on by the Lord to go to a specific place, where at a specific time, he is told to go talk with a specific person who happens to be reading about the prophecy of Jesus' death in Isaiah, and he is wondering what the prophecy means. Evangelists have a leading from God that helps them to find these ideal circumstances and have these appointments from God that are divine. We can all experience these, however, the reason evangelists may see them more often, may just be because of their willingness to take the opportunities.

(5) **They have an ability to ask the right questions, preach the gospel creatively, and lead people to the Lord because of it (vs. 30-40)**

(a) Philip asks the perfect question to this man he was sent to preach to. His question opens the door to preach Christ to this man and then not just leave it there (he has sown the seed) but to lead him to get saved and get baptized

3. If you feel that this may be a gift you have, you are responsible to use it. This means if you slip and get lazy or fall away, you will have the most blood on your hands (Eze. 33:1-6). You will also be responsible to train, encourage, and help others who really struggle with evangelism. Those who don't have this gift, can get very nervous about evangelizing, you have to be one who can help them along. Souls are at stake.

B. Pastor

1. A pastor in the Bible is someone who is responsible for the shepherding and care of a flock of people. (*pastor="pasture" or "shepherding")* It is an ordained office in the structure of the local church as we find in the pastoral epistles (specifically 1 Timothy and Titus).
   a) The words Elder, Bishop, and Pastor are all used interchangeably in the Bible talking about the official position of a pastor in a church.
2. The gift of pastoring and the call to be a pastor do not necessarily go directly hand in hand. Some that feel the call to be in full time ministry as a pastor, do not naturally have all of the characteristics of a gifted pastor. They may have to work harder at some things and God will teach them those things because they are desiring a good thing, (1 Tim. 3:1) if it is in fact God calling them to ministry.
   a) Some have the gift of pastoring, the heart of a pastor, and they will never be in an official, full time, vocational ministry position as they don't feel that call.
   b) Today we are talking specifically about the gift of a heart of a pastor that anyone can possess, and some may use in an official capacity and some may not.
3. Responsibilities of those who have this gift
   a) 1 Pet. 5:1-4; John 10:11-14
      (1) Those who have this gift, have such a heart for the church of God and of caring for the "sheep" of God, that they are consumed with the care of the sheep at all times. They think about others, pray for others, ask how others are doing, bear the burdens of others, give help and council to others, and overall are willing to lay down their lives for others (in both the literal and physical sense)
4. Examples of people who were gifted with the heart of a pastor
   a) Jesus Christ
      (1) Luke 13:34-35; Matt. 18:10-14; Heb. 13:20
   b) David
      (1) Eze. 34:23; Ezek. 37:24; Psalm 23:1; 1 Sam. 17:34-36
5. Those entrusted with this gift have been put in a position that God takes very seriously. God has a deep love for his people (he is the great shepherd) and if he has entrusted

you to take care of his sheep, you ought to be very vigilant about it. Especially if God calls you to use this gift in a vocational/official ministry capacity. Some can misuse this gift to take advantage of, lord over, or lead sheep astray. This type of misuse of this gift will result in eternal consequences for souls around you.This is a large burden to bear and it cannot be taken lightly.

C. Teacher

1. A teacher is someone who is able to communicate information in an effective way so as to inform and "teach" others about the Bible in a very practical way.
    a) Someone with the gift of a teacher is someone who can take biblical principles that they have been taught and clearly communicate them to others in such a way that they can clearly understand it and apply it to their lives.
2. Different ways that someone with the gift of a teacher can teach
    a) **Publically**- Someone who is a gifted teacher is able to teach the Bible publically in an effective and clear way. They may experience less fear of public speaking than some, but will most likely experience the fear of public speaking to some extent regardless. (this gift does not necessarily mean that you won't be bothered by public speaking but that you will be able to do it regardless by the gift God gave you)
    b) **Individually**- Someone who is a gifted teacher is able to teach the Bible privately in an effective and clear way. They are engaging and practical in how they teach the Bible to their disciples, friends, co-workers, family, etc… on a personal and private basis.
        (1) Having the gift of teaching does not mean that you will necessarily have just one or both of these types of teaching abilities. You may be able to teach well just privately, or just publically, or both.
3. Examples of biblical teachers both private and public
    a) Apollos and Aquila and Priscilla - Acts 18:24-28
    b) Paul- 1 Tim. 2:7
    c) Aaron (Exo. 4:14)
4. Teachers are not those who are responsible for finding new biblical truth, conveying wisdom, or prophesying of future events; they are those that are needed to convey what God has said and teach biblical truth in an effective way that helps the hearers to learn. Teachers are especially gifted at this and they are needed within the local church. Teachers have a great responsibility to use their gifts because if they do not, then there will be a lack of learning and of knowledge in the church (Prov. 1:1-7)
    a) Knowledge is important. When we get biblical knowledge, it allows us the opportunity to obey and live godly lives. The fear of the Lord is the beginning of knowledge and there are many important things to learn after that; teachers help us to learn those things.

I. As we saw in the first 3 gifts today, there is so much that the Bible has to say about each of these gifts. They are all very important within the body of Christ and they are all important to God. These gifts are all more publicly seen, but no more important than the gifts we will look at in the coming weeks. If anything, they just come with a greater burden of responsibility and can be detrimental to the body if they are not used correctly.



Wednesday, May 18th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- ROMANS 12:6-8

I. Today we will be looking at 3 more of the spiritual gifts that we find in the Bible. These gifts are not as acclaimed by many as some of the other more public gifts, but are just as, if not more important. These gifts get no glory, they have no luster, and they are often done _____ ____ _____, but they are listed by God as spiritual gifts for a reason. This reason is because they are hard to do because they don't come naturally to most. Anyone with these gifts is essential to the body of Christ and the body cannot function without them.

II. Romans 12:6-8

A. _____ with simplicity

1. This is for those who find it easier to give freely and more abundantly than most. It says giving with simplicity, implying that the giving is not complicated or with any strings attached, but given freely and of a good heart attitude.
2. The story of the "Giver" and the "Goer"
3. Biblical examples of givers and their impact on the ministry
    a) Phill. 4:14-17- Giving to the ministry that fruit may abound to your account
    b) 1 Cor. 16:1-3- When and how we ought to give (liberality=abundance of your money)
    c) 2 Cor. 8:1-5- The testimony of the giving of the church in Macedonia who was funding work in other churches
4. The heart of the gifted giver
    a) 2 Cor. 9:6-7
5. Giving is not just talking about money exclusively, we can also give of our time and talents with the same heart of giving.

B. _____ with diligence

1. This gift describes those who are supernaturally gifted at ruling and leading God's people in the execution of a plan. The gift of the pastor is more about the heart of leading God's people, while this gift of ruling with diligence is more about the execution and practical ways that someone leads and executes the mission at hand for the Lord.
2. People who have this gift, as we see in the Bible, they have a strong personality and are strong leaders who are able to pull people along and lead them. This is how things get done!

(1) Exo. 18:21,25; 1 Kings 11:28; Romans 13:1-7

(2) First mention of ruler; Gen. 41:43

b) Rulers are people that are wise and have understanding

(1) Deut. 1:13

c) Rulers are people that fear God and are just

(1) 2 Sam. 23:3; Lev. 25:43

d) Rulers are people who diligently command and get things done in a correct way; not like a dictator

(1) Prov. 6:6-8; 12:24; 28:15

3. Examples of biblical rulers

(1) Moses- Acts 7:35;

(2) David- 2 Sam. 7:8; 1 Chron. 11:2

C. Shewing _____ with cheerfulness

1. Those with this gift are able to show mercy to others even in the most difficult and darkest of situations where others may not be able to show mercy. Mercy is when someone is willing to forgive and overlook offenses when punishment is rightly deserved. Those with this gift do not show mercy grudgingly, but with cheerfulness.
2. This gift is special in that it is very close to the heart of God
   a) Num. 14:18; 1 Kings 3:6; 2 Chron. 1:8; Psa. 145:8; 57:10; 86:13; 103:11; 108:4; Eph. 2:4; Lam. 3:22-23
3. Mercy must be mixed with truth
   a) Psalm 85:10; 86:15; 100:5
4. Biblical examples of those with this gift
   a) Jesus- John 8:1-11; Matt. 18:21-22; Luke 23:34
   b) Joseph- Gen. 50:15-21
   c) David- Isa. 55:3; Acts 13:34

III. Many of us here may not have these gifts, however we all need to be doing these things regardless of how easy it comes to us. For those here with some of these gifts, you are _____and especially gifted by God to use your gift not only for its natural purpose, but also for helping others who struggle to do these things. We all can and should desire to be gifted in these areas. If you struggle in any of these but desire to do better, pray and ask God. Desire spiritual gifts, to edify and help the body of Christ. He will answer this prayer and he will help you or send someone who has these gifts to help you. Finally, reach out and find those around you with these gifts and listen to and learn from them.



Wednesday, May 18th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- Romans 12:6-8

I. Today we will be looking at 3 more of the spiritual gifts that we find in the Bible. These gifts are not as acclaimed by many as some of the other more public gifts, but are just as, if not more important. These gifts get no glory, they have no luster, and they are often done behind the scenes, but they are listed by God as spiritual gifts for a reason. This reason is because they are hard to do because they don't come naturally to most. Anyone with these gifts is essential to the body of Christ and the body cannot function without them.

II. Romans 12:6-8

A. Giving with simplicity

1. This is for those who find it easier to give freely and more abundantly than most. It says giving with simplicity, implying that the giving is not complicated or with any strings attached, but given freely and of a good heart attitude.
    a) Those with this gift bless the church in ways that others never can. The people who give this way make the work and the ministries and missions we do possible.
2. Those with this gift also have a supernatural ability to see and meet needs within the body. They see where they can give towards the work and they do it with a cheerful heart!
3. The story of the "Giver" and the "Goer"
    a) Say there is someone who wants to use their gifts and go on a missions trip that God has called them to. They don't have a lot of extra money but they know God is calling them and so they sign up and they trust God with the rest. Then someone who is a gifted giver, gives to help pay to fund the way of the person going on the trip. Is the person who is hands on serving the Lord across the world more important than the gifted giver who is funding their way? Of course not. That gifted Giver made this missions trip

possible for that person who was called on the missions trip. Many will never even hear or know about the person who gave the money and made all of this possible. That does not mean that they are any less important in the work of the Lord.

4. We all must use the gifts that God has given us for the betterment of the ministry and glory of God. No matter what the gifts are, or how they are seen by others, they are gifts from God and they ALL matter!
5. Biblical examples of givers and their impact on the ministry
    a) Phill. 4:14-17- Giving to the ministry that fruit may abound to your account
    b) 1 Cor. 16:1-3- When and how we ought to give (liberality=abundance of your money)
    c) 2 Cor. 8:1-5- The testimony of the giving of the church in Macedonia who was funding work in other churches
6. The heart of the gifted giver
    a) 2 Cor. 9:6-7
7. Giving is not just talking about money exclusively, we can also give of our time and talents with the same heart of giving.
    a) If you are someone who gives of your time and talents in an extraordinary way, you are also a gifted giver; don't let anyone fool you into thinking that giving is just about your money, it is only 1 of the 3 things you can give!
    b) We focused a lot of our attention on giving of money, this is because according to the bible, if you are unwilling to give of your money, they you likely won't give of your time/talent. It is a good indicator of where your heart is, so it is a good way to judge how you are as a giver.
        (1) Luke 12:34- For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.

B. Ruling with diligence

1. This gift describes those who are supernaturally gifted at ruling and leading God's people in the execution of a plan. The gift of the pastor is more about the heart of leading God's people, while this gift of ruling with diligence is more about the execution and practical ways that someone leads and executes the mission at hand for the Lord.

2. People who have this gift, as we see in the Bible, they have a strong personality and are strong leaders who are able to pull people along and lead them. This is how things get done!
    (1) Exo. 18:21,25; 1 Kings 11:28; Romans 13:1-7
    (2) Industrious- Diligent in business or study. Consistent, regularly and habitually involved in hard work
    (3) First mention of ruler; Gen. 41:43

b) Rulers are people that are wise and have understanding

(1) Deut. 1:13

c) Rulers are people that fear God and are just

(1) 2 Sam. 23:3; Lev. 25:43

d) Rulers are people who diligently command and get things done in a correct way; not like a dictator

(1) Prov. 12:24; 28:15

3. Examples of biblical rulers
    (1) Moses- Acts 7:35
    (2) David- 2 Sam. 7:8; 1 Chron. 11:2

C. Shewing mercy with cheerfulness

1. Those with this gift are able to show mercy to others even in the most difficult and darkest of situations where others may not be able to show mercy. Mercy is when someone is willing to forgive and overlook offenses when punishment is rightly deserved. Those with this gift do not show mercy grudgingly, but with cheerfulness.
2. This gift is special in that it is very close to the heart of God
    a) PICK STUDENTS TO READ EACH OF THESE OUT LOUD
    b) Num. 14:18; 1 Kings 3:6; 2 Chron. 1:8; Psa. 145:8; 57:10; 86:13; 103:11; 108:4; Eph. 2:4; Lam. 3:22-23
        (1) So many times, some of us are only merciful to a point, and we tend to remember the old things we “forgave” people for. Thank God that he is not like that. His mercies are new each and every day!

c) This type of mercy simply comes easier for some, some are gifted with this heart. However, we are all still called to be merciful (Luke 6:35-36; Micah 6:8)

3. Mercy must be mixed with truth
   a) Psalm 85:10; 86:15; 100:5
   b) Having this gift, you will always tend to want to show mercy in all situations. Your heart is burdened for the downtrodden and the broken. However, you must mix this mercy with the truth of God. It cannot be all mercy, or all truth; it must always be a healthy mix of both.
4. Biblical examples of those with this gift
   a) Jesus- John 8:1-11; Matt. 18:21-22; Luke 23:34
   b) Joseph- Gen. 50:15-21
   c) David- Isa. 55:3; Acts 13:34
      (1) We don't have time to study out these "sure mercies" tonight, however it is a good study into the life of David, and as a man after God's own heart, David shares in this gift that is close to the heart of God as well.
5. If you have this gift you have the ability to reach people that are downtrodden and in bad situations, when most write them off. You have the ability to restore brethren who are far from the Lord for whatever reason or circumstance. You must use this gift or so many people will go unreached.

III. Many of us here may not have these gifts, however we all need to be doing these things regardless of how easy it comes to us. For those here with some of these gifts, you are responsible and especially gifted by God to use your gift not only for its natural purpose, but also for helping others who struggle to do these things. We all can and should desire to be gifted in these areas. If you struggle in any of these but desire to do better, pray and ask God. Desire spiritual gifts, to edify and help the body of Christ. He will answer this prayer and he will help you or send someone who has these gifts to help you. Finally, reach out and find those around you with these gifts and listen to and learn from them.



Wednesday, May 25th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- Romans 12:6-8

I. Today we will be looking at two gifts that are absolutely essential in the body of Christ: ministering and exhorting. The importance of each of these cannot be overstated, yet they are very different and separate gifts. Anyone who has either of these gifts is _____ for much because of how hurt the body of Christ would be in ministry if they were not using these gifts for the Lord. Anyone who feels that they do not have these gifts ought to consider praying to the Lord and asking him to bestow these gifts to them. We all must be doing these things regardless of if we are gifted in it or not, and we all should desire these gifts so that we might edify the body of Christ even more!

II. Romans 12:6-8

A. _____

1. This gift describes those who are supernaturally gifted at “serving” with special talents and abilities within the body of Christ. This term is most closely associated with “servant”.
2. **People with this gift may find the following are true about themselves:**
   a) They are always serving in multiple areas of ministry
   b) They are always seeking out people/circumstances where they can serve/minister to help the body of Christ
   c) Their first response when approached about new ministry opportunities is to always say yes (this needs to be balanced, however, people with this gift are burdened to serve everywhere they can)
3. **Some examples of ministers in the Bible**
   a) Levites (priests)- Jer. 33:21-22; Eze. 40:46; 42:14; Joel 1:9
   b) Angels- Mark 1:13; Psa. 104:4; Heb. 1:7; Matt. 4:11; 2 Cor. 11:14-15
      (1) The angels are the servants of God. They are his messengers, carry out heavenly duties (in Revelation you can clearly see the angels ministering all over the place), and are involved in many acts of service for God
      (1) Rev. 8:3, 6-7; 9:11; 14:6; 16:3-4
   c) The disciples and followers of Jesus
      (1) Matt. 8:15; 27:55-The women who followed Jesus
      (2) Acts 1:15-17; 6:1-4- The disciples and deacons
   d) Pastors

(1) 1 Thess. 3:2; 1 Tim. 4:6; 2 Cor. 11:23; 1 Cor. 3:5

4. **Those who are great ministers, make the best leaders**
    a) Mark 10:35-45

B. _____

1. This gift describes those who have the supernatural ability to encourage, persuade, and inspire others
    a) Those with this gift are able to spur others on to do things that they maybe normally would not. They have an ability to encourage and inspire others when others are not
2. **Exhorting has two guidelines in the bible** (2 Tim. 4:2)
    a) **Exhort with longsuffering**- We are to exhort and not stop exhorting. When people don't take to it and they don't listen to it. Continue to exhort! You cannot grow weary in well doing with this. People who are gifted with exhortation are gifted with passion. Passion is what makes effective exhorting. If you give up on it too soon, people will see right through it and won't believe what you say. (Prov. 25:15)
    b) **Exhort with doctrine-** Exhort in the truth. Exhort by teaching things that are correct and godly and not leading people astray. This gift is very powerful in that it has the ability to change people's minds and to persuade them; this means that it comes with a GREAT responsibility to not steer people the wrong way with bad doctrine.
3. **Biblical examples of people with this gift**
    a) Peter- Acts 2:37-41; Luke 22:32
    b) Barnabas- Acts 4:36-37; 11:19-26
        (1) He was so known for his gift of exhortation, he was nicknamed Barnabas, which means " son of consolation", by the other apostles!
    c) Paul- Acts 13:43; 18:4, 13; 19:8; 14:19-22
4. **We all must be exhorters in some way or another**

III. All of us are called to be servants (ministers) and to passionately preach the gospel and make disciples (exhort). For those of us who are gifted at these things it will come much easier and so we must help those who struggle with these things. For those who struggle at these, reach out to those who you see as ministers and exhorters; reach out to people who serve constantly and who passionately preach and _____ others. They will help you to desire these gifts to edify the body of Christ and bring glory to Jesus Christ!



Wednesday, May 25th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- Romans 12:6-8

I. Today we will be looking at two gifts that are absolutely essential in the body of Christ: ministering and exhorting. The importance of each of these cannot be overstated, yet they are very different and separate gifts. Anyone who has either of these gifts is responsible for much because of how hurt the body of Christ would be in ministry if they were not using these gifts for the Lord. Anyone who feels that they do not have these gifts ought to consider praying to the Lord and asking him to bestow these gifts to them. We all must be doing these things regardless of if we are gifted in it or not, and we all should desire these gifts so that we might edify the body of Christ even more!

II. Romans 12:6-8

A. Ministering

1. This gift describes those who are supernaturally gifted at "serving" with special talents and abilities within the body of Christ. This term is most closely associated with "servant".
    a) People with this gift are able to serve more abundantly and naturally than most. They may be one who serves in multiple areas of ministry and are constantly reminded to not "burn out" as they are known to "burn the candle at both ends"
2. **People with this gift may find the following are true about themselves:**
    a) They are always serving in multiple areas of ministry
        (1) Many people simply sign up for serving in a ministry because they are tired of being hounded on by the other members in the church about where they are serving. This is a dutiful service. This is not the heart of someone with this gift. They desire deeply to serve anywhere they can.
    b) They are always seeking out people/circumstances where they can serve/minister to help the body of Christ
    c) Their first response when approached about new ministry opportunities is to always say yes (this needs to be balanced, however, people with this gift are burdened to serve everywhere they can)
3. **Some examples of ministers in the Bible**
    a) Levites (priests)- Jer. 33:21-22; Eze. 40:46; 42:14; Joel 1:9

(1) In Exodus and Numbers alone the word “minister” shows up 31x referring to the Levites and priests

(2) These were those who were in charge of the many laws, sacrifices, keeping of the Lords house, etc… Their whole life was devoted to “serving” the Lord in all of these aspects. They were the Lord’s servants (just like modern day pastors are supposed to be servants; also called “ministers”)

b) Angels- Mark 1:13; Psa. 104:4; Heb. 1:7; Matt. 4:11; 2 Cor. 11:14-15

(1) The angels are the servants of God. They are his messengers, carry out heavenly duties (in Revelation you can clearly see the angels ministering all over the place), and are involved in many acts of service for God

(a) Pick Students to read: Rev. 8:3, 6-7; 9:11; 14:6; 16:3-4

c) The disciples and followers of Jesus

(1) Matt. 8:15; 27:55-The women who followed Jesus

(2) Acts 1:15-17; 6:1-4- The disciples and deacons

d) Pastors

(1) 1 Thess. 3:2; 1 Tim. 4:6; 2 Cor. 11:23; 1 Cor. 3:5

4. **Those who are great ministers, make the best leaders**

a) Mark 10:35-45 (MUST READ)

(1) Those who seek a position (Jesus compares them to worldly Gentile leaders) are NOT good leaders, they are “lorders” over the people. Ministers and servants are those who are the best leaders.

(2) Also notice that Jesus was a minister. This issue was close to his heart. He was not a “lorder” over people, but he was a leader and he was a minister.

B. Exhorting

1. This gift describes those who have the supernatural ability to encourage, persuade, and inspire others

a) Those with this gift are able to spur others on to do things that they maybe normally would not. They have an ability to encourage and inspire others when others are not

b) They are different than rulers in that ruling deals with the ways someone is gifted to organize and practically carry out a plan. Exhorting is more about giving people a spirited push to do something. It speaks to the ability to influence people and their thinking and not just carry out a plan

2. **Exhorting has two guidelines in the bible** (2 Tim. 4:2)

(1) The context is Paul talking to Timothy, a pastor, about preaching! Preaching and exhorting are very closely connected.

b) **Exhort with longsuffering**- We are to exhort and not stop exhorting. When people don’t take to it and they don’t listen to it. Continue to exhort!

You cannot grow weary in well doing with this. People who are gifted with exhortation are gifted with passion. Passion is what makes effective exhorting. If you give up on it too soon, people will see right through it and won't believe what you say. (Prov. 25:15)

c) **Exhort with doctrine-** Exhort in the truth. Exhort by teaching things that are correct and godly and not leading people astray. This gift is very powerful in that it has the ability to change people's minds and to persuade them; this means that it comes with a GREAT responsibility to not steer people the wrong way with bad doctrine.

3. **Biblical examples of people with this gift**
   a) Peter- Acts 2:37-41; Luke 22:32
      (1) Peter was a man who was not perfect. His passions caused him to make many mistakes and put his foot in his mouth many times. For these same reasons, Peter was chosen to lead the disciples when Jesus left. For these same reasons, Peter was an amazing exhorter and was able to influence people for Christ in a great way! Passionate people have a great ability to have and use this gift for the same influence for Christ.
   b) Barnabas- Acts 4:36-37; 11:19-26
      (1) He was so known for his gift of exhortation, he was nicknamed Barnabas, which means " son of consolation", by the other apostles!
   c) Paul- Acts 13:43; 18:4,13; 19:8; 14:19-22
4. **We all must be exhorters in some way or another**
   a) We are all called to preach the gospel and to be disciples. When we truly believe in what we are teaching, we will teach with passion (we will exhort) and this will make us persuasive. We cannot afford to not exhort during our Christian lives

III. All of us are called to be servants (ministers) and to passionately preach the gospel and make disciples (exhort). For those of us who are gifted at these things it will come much easier and so we must help those who struggle with these things. For those who struggle at these, reach out to those who you see as ministers and exhorters; reach out to people who serve constantly and who passionately preach and encourage others. They will help you to desire these gifts to edify the body of Christ and bring glory to Jesus Christ!



Wednesday, June 1st, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- 1 COR. 12:8-10, 28; 7:7-8

I. Today we will be looking at three new spiritual gifts. Two of these gifts may be more prevalent in our church because of the fact that we are so well taught and trained on the bible and because we do biblical discipleship (word of knowledge and word of wisdom). This means that we are more _____than most for what we know and using what we know. For those in here who have maybe wondered if they are gifted with singleness, we will see what a unique and special gift this is. You will be left with no doubt as to what you need to do to examine if you have this gift, or to not neglect this gift if you do in fact have it.

II. 1 Corinthians 12:8-10, 28

A. Word of _____

1. This gift is for those who are supernaturally gifted with the ability to not just retain biblical facts/knowledge, but to also apply this knowledge to the right situation at the right time in order to help the body of Christ.
2. Their are differences between knowledge, wisdom, and understanding in the bible (Prov. 2:1-11)
    a) **Knowledge**- facts/information that is learned
    b) **Wisdom**- the correct use/application of knowledge
    c) **Understanding**- getting the bigger purpose behind the knowledge and wisdom you have. Seeing and applying it through a godly lens. (Psa. 73:17)
3. How this works out in the world
    a) An **uneducated** person may have wisdom but not knowledge
    b) An **educated** person may have knowledge but not wisdom
    c) **Anyone** with knowledge/wisdom, without the spirit of God, will not have true understanding
4. Biblical examples of people with wisdom
    a) **Solomon**- He is perhaps the most famous “wise person” in the bible. This makes sense since he is the wisest person who ever lived (1 Kings 3:6-12; 16-28; 4:29-30)
    b) Joseph- He was supernaturally gifted wisdom just as Solomon was (Acts 7:9-10)
5. Just as we saw these men in the Bible supernaturally given the gift of wisdom, we too can ask for wisdom and God says he gives it **liberally!** (James 1:5; Prov. 4:5-7)
    a) Those with this gift need to heed this biblical reminder (James 3:13)

B. Word of _____

1. People who are gifted with this are supernaturally gifted at recalling and presenting correct biblical facts, information, doctrine, etc… (Prov. 19:27; Prov. 23:12)
2. People with this gift are able to edify the body when they apply the gift and the knowledge they know. Ways this can be done may include:
    a) Giving answers to tough bible questions

b) Helping new/immature Christians to learn the bible
c) Gaining interest from non-believers and believers who are not interested in the bible simply by talking about the bible in a way that is interesting and makes sense
d) Being the person that people go to with Bible questions
e) Typically being able to explain the bible with many biblical proofs/references off hand in the right situations/times
f) Combatting false teachers/doctrines

3. Those with this gift can often times here or read something one time and be able to recall it, by the aid of the Holy Ghost, at the right time/situation
4. People with this gift can be written off at times as "know it alls" or as being "puffed up". These accusations can be true of anyone, but especially those with this gift if it is not used correctly (1 Cor. 8:1)
5. Biblical examples of people with this gift
   a) Job- (Job 33:1-5; 35:16)
   b) Stephen- (Acts 7:1-53)
   c) Apollos- (Acts 18:24-28)

III. 1 Corinthians 7:7-8

A. _____

1. People with this gift have a supernatural ability to serve the Lord untethered. They are free to go and do whatever/whenever the Lord calls them. They are especially gifted to do this without the need of a spouse who is there to support them as many others who serve the Lord have.
2. Those with this gift are supernaturally enabled to stay single by the grace of God, but they are not alone
3. This is a rarer gift than most. It is a calling that God makes clear in ones life and that he honors and empowers them to do. The bible calls for us to not be alone (Gen. 2:18; Ecc. 4:9-12) but to marry, however, with this gift you are enabled by God himself to stay single and mind only the things of the Lord (1 Cor. 7:32-35)
4. Biblical examples of people with this gift
   a) Paul (1 Cor. 7:7-8; 27-28)
   b) Jesus (Matt. 8:18-22)
   c) Jeremiah (Jer. 16:1-4)

IV. We have all been trained so well and taught the bible so well at our church that many may feel they have the gifts of word of wisdom and knowledge. Since these gifts are able to be obtained, this very well may be the case. However, to whom much is given, much is required. We must use our knowledge and wisdom with _____, which comes from having a close walk with the Lord. For those who are wondering about if they may have the gift of singleness, do not be afraid of having or not having it. Simply walk with the Lord and pray about these things and it will be abundantly clear if you have this gift. It is such a special gift to have and a rare gift; a gift that people like Jesus, Paul, and Jeremiah had (good company to be in). Do not neglect your gifts, embrace and use them to bring glory to God!



Wednesday, June 1st, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- 1 COR. 12:8-10, 28; 7:7-8

I. Today we will be looking at three new spiritual gifts. Two of these gifts may be more prevalent in our church because of the fact that we are so well taught and trained on the bible and because we do biblical discipleship (word of knowledge and word of wisdom). This means that we are more **responsible** than most for what we know and using what we know. For those in here who have maybe wondered if they are gifted with singleness, we will see what a unique and special gift this is. You will be left with no doubt as to what you need to do to examine if you have this gift, or to not neglect this gift if you do in fact have it.

II. 1 Corinthians 12:8-10, 28

A. Word of Wisdom

1. This gift is for those who are supernaturally gifted with the ability to not just retain biblical facts/knowledge, but to also apply this knowledge to the right situation at the right time in order to help the body of Christ.
2. Their are differences between knowledge, wisdom, and understanding in the bible (Prov. 2:1-11)
    a) **Knowledge**- facts/information that is learned
    b) **Wisdom**- the correct use/application of knowledge
    c) **Understanding**- getting the bigger purpose behind the knowledge and wisdom you have. Seeing and applying it through a godly lens. (Psa. 73:17)
3. How this works out in the world
    a) An **uneducated** person may have wisdom but not knowledge
    b) An **educated** person may have knowledge but not wisdom
    c) **Anyone** with knowledge/wisdom, without the spirit of God, will not have true understanding
4. Biblical examples of people with wisdom
    a) **Solomon**- He is perhaps the most famous “wise person” in the bible. This makes sense since he is the wisest person who ever lived
        (1) 1 Kings 3:6-12; 16-28; 4:29-30
            (a) When you are given wisdom and understanding supernaturally from the Lord, you will have more wisdom than anything the world has to offer. Not only does God

show you knowledge applied, but you are able to understand it in the greater picture as well (Egypt is a type of the world). The world may continue to grow in knowledge, and maybe even some wisdom, but not understanding.

b) Joseph- He was supernaturally gifted wisdom just as Solomon was

(1) Acts 7:9-10

5. Just as we saw these men in the Bible supernaturally given the gift of wisdom, we too can ask for wisdom and God says he gives it **liberally!**
   a) James 1:5; Prov. 4:5-7
   b) The body of Christ desperately needs people with this gift. They are able to bring comfort and practical advise to those in need of it.
   c) At times, people with this gift can be too heavily relied upon and can cause laziness in others, however, that cannot stop them from using their gift to edify the body.
   d) Those with this gift need to heed this biblical reminder
      (1) James 3:13

B. Word of Knowledge

1. People who are gifted with this are supernaturally gifted at recalling and presenting correct biblical facts, information, doctrine, etc…
   a) Prov. 19:27; Prov. 23:12
   b) People with this gift are not necessarily naturally gifted with a good memory. This can be the case, however, many times it is also not the case, which even greater shows the supernatural aspect of these gifts
2. People with this gift are able to edify the body when they apply the gift and the knowledge they know. Ways this can be done may include:
   a) Giving answers to tough bible questions
   b) Helping new/immature Christians to learn the bible
   c) Gaining interest from non-believers and believers who are not interested in the bible simply by talking about the bible in a way that is interesting and makes sense
   d) Being the person that people go to with Bible questions
   e) Typically being able to explain the bible with many biblical proofs/references off hand in the right situations/times
   f) Combatting false teachers/doctrines
3. Those with this gift can often times here or read something one time and be able to recall it, by the aid of the Holy Ghost, at the right time/situation

4. People with this gift can be written off at times as “know it alls” or as being “puffed up”. These accusations can be true of anyone, but especially those with this gift if it is not used correctly (1 Cor. 8:1)
    a) The key is to use the gift with charity and with a desire to help edify the body, not to just look ultra “spiritual” and smart
5. Biblical examples of people with this gift
    a) Job- (Job 33:1-5; 35:16)
        (1) He showed he had much knowledge, but not much wisdom
    b) Stephen- (Acts 7:1-53)
        (1) He gives this amazing, detailed, off the cuff message displaying his gift of word of knowledge (he has wisdom as well but knowledge is shown here even greater)
    c) Apollos- (Acts 18:24-28)
        (1) It is said of him that he was eloquent and mighty in the scriptures, however, he was still believing and preaching the baptism of John, which showed a lack of wisdom and understanding

III. 1 Corinthians 7:7-8

A. Singleness

1. People with this gift have a supernatural ability to serve the Lord untethered. They are free to go and do whatever/whenever the Lord calls them. They are especially gifted to do this without the need of a spouse who is there to support them as many others who serve the Lord have.
2. Those with this gift are supernaturally enabled to stay single by the grace of God, but they are not alone
3. This is a rarer gift than most. It is a calling that God makes clear in ones life and that he honors and empowers them to do. The bible calls for us to not be alone (Gen. 2:18; Ecc. 4:9-12) but to marry, however, with this gift you are enabled by God himself to stay single and mind only the things of the Lord (1 Cor. 7:32-35)
    a) Some becomes scared that they may have this gift after they haven’t found someone to be with after many years. However, gifts are not a curse, but a blessing and something that is bound within us. If you do not desire to be single, you very likely are not gifted in this and should not worry, but rather you should pray about this.
4. Biblical examples of people with this gift
    a) Paul (1 Cor. 7:7-8; 27-28)
        (1) He wrote many of the words that we read above about this gift. It is evident that this attitude of singleness is abounding from him and it is clear he was called to it and gifted at it

b) Jesus (Matt. 8:18-22)

(1) Jesus was single for many reasons but the fact that he was not bound in his work here is a huge example for singles to follow. He was 100% focused on making disciples and the word of the Lord

c) Jeremiah (Jer. 16:1-4)

(a) He was called by God to be single. He was a great prophet who never had any visible fruit of his ministry, maybe the Lord needed him to be 100% focused on him alone.

(i) Jeremiah does contain some of the most prophecy of any book of the bible

IV. We have all been trained so well and taught the bible so well at our church that many may feel they have the gifts of word of wisdom and knowledge. Since these gifts are able to be obtained, this very well may be the case. However, to whom much is given, much is required. We must use our knowledge and wisdom with **understanding**, which comes from having a close walk with the Lord. For those who are wondering about if they may have the gift of singleness, do not be afraid of having or not having it. Simply walk with the Lord and pray about these things and it will be abundantly clear if you have this gift. It is such a special gift to have and a rare gift; a gift that people like Jesus, Paul, and Jeremiah had (good company to be in). Do not neglect your gifts, embrace and use them to bring glory to God!



Wednesday, June 8th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- 1 COR. 12:8-10,28

I. Today we will look at 3 more spiritual gifts as they are found in the bible. Many will probably find that they can relate to at least 1 or more of these gifts we will look at today. They may be more common than other gifts, but they come with the same level of _____and care that any gift requires. If you think you may have any of these, listen closely and examine whether or not you are using your gifts in the way God desires.

II. 1 Corinthians 12:8-10, 28

A. _____ ____ _____

1. This gift is for those who can sense whether something being said or done is godly, righteous, biblically correct or not. They can rightly interpret statements, situations, environments, and people in general (1 John 4:1-6)
2. **People with this gift are able to:**
   a) Discern between those who really love and serve the Lord and those who are faking it (Malachi 3:18)
   b) Discern the real meaning behind peoples statements (John 3:1-10)
   c) Discern the deeper things of the world because of the spirit of God in them revealing it to them (1 Cor. 2:9-15)
3. **This gift can be obtained just like any other gift**
   a) Solomon asks for this gift of discerning of spirits and he gets it (1 Kings 3:9)
   b) People who are older and have had their senses exercised obtain this gift (Hebrews 5:14)
   c) When you spend time in the word of God long enough and you allow the word of God to sink deep into your heart, you can use it to discern, and maybe even obtain this gift (Heb. 4:12)
4. **This gift does not guarantee 100% success of discerning in all situations**
   a) This can lead to people with this gift sounding “judgmental” or always pessimistic
   b) The only thing to do is continue to use your gift and try the spirits the best you can. Time will prove all things
5. **Biblical examples of people with this gift**
   a) Jesus- Matt. 15:7-9; Luke 9:46-50
   b) Paul- Acts 16:16-18

B. _____

1. Those with this gift are supernaturally able to see and meet the needs of others (oftentimes even before they know they have a need), and to do it with great quietness and ease.
2. **The heart of those with this gift**

a) Prov. 3:27; Gal. 6:10

3. **People with this gift go out of their way to help others**
    a) Duet. 22:4
4. **Ways that people with this gift demonstrate help (these are just a few examples):**
    a) Prayer (2 Cor. 1:11)
    b) Providing meals, rides, clothes, cleaning, helping someone move, helping someone who is going through a loss, etc…. (innumerable ways)
    c) Being a fatherly/motherly/brotherly/sisterly figure in someones life
    d) Using a trade/talent you have to help someone in need
    e) Providing good biblical advice to someone going through a tough time
    f) Etc….
5. **Biblical examples of people with this gift**
    a) Moses- Exodus 2:16-19
    b) Aquila and Priscilla- Romans 16:3
    c) Urbane- Romans 16:9

C. _____

1. People with this gift are able to put together creative, effective, organizational plans in an area(s) of ministry in the church that causes it to function well
2. While rulers are all about executing plans and achieving goals through leading people, this gift is for those who are good at organizing and creating and doing behind the scenes "administrative" things that help the work of the Lord to be done at the highest level possible.
    a) James 3:4 displays this relationship perfectly
3. **Those with this gift are organized people who are good at helping to establish order**
    a) 1 Cor. 11:34; 14:40; 16:1; Col. 2:5
4. **God loves order and so people with this gift have the special ability to help the ministry and please the Lord by bringing order**
    a) Num. 24:5
5. **People with this gift have leadership qualities, but are typically better at the "governing" part of things than the "enacting" of plans**
    a) Aaron and Moses worked together in this way (Exodus 4:14-16; 7:1-2)
6. **Biblical examples of people with this gift**
    a) Jethro- Exodus 18:13-27
    b) Luke- Luke 1:1-4; Acts 1:1
    c) Titus- Titus 1:5

III. Any of us that feel that we have any of these gifts is responsible to use them. We cannot neglect the gifts God has entrusted us with. The body of Christ will _____if you choose to neglect your gift, no matter what it is. If you don't have these, but desire to develop them, pray and ask God to help you with that. If you have these gifts and you are not using them to the extent that you need to be, search the word of God about your gift and do everything that God is calling you to do with your gift in order to bring glory to God!



Wednesday, June 8th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- 1 COR. 12:8-10,28

I. Today we will look at 3 more spiritual gifts as they are found in the bible. Many will probably find that they can relate to at least 1 or more of these gifts we will look at today. They may be more common than other gifts, but they come with the same level of **responsibility** and care that any gift requires. If you think you may have any of these, listen closely and examine whether or not you are using your gifts in the way God desires.

II. 1 Corinthians 12:8-10, 28

A. Discerning of Spirits

1. This gift is for those who can sense whether something being said or done is godly, righteous, biblically correct or not. They can rightly interpret statements, situations, environments, and people in general (1 John 4:1-6)
2. **People with this gift are able to:**
   a) Discern between those who really love and serve the Lord and those who are faking it (Malachi 3:18)
   b) Discern the real meaning behind peoples statements (John 3:1-3)
   c) Discern the deeper things of the world because of the spirit of God in them revealing it to them (1 Cor. 2:9-15) **(READ IN BIBLES)**
      (1) This can include a deeper understanding of the spiritual aspects to the events going on in the world and more. It's a deeper judgment of all things and how they relate to the spiritual warfare going on behind the scenes
      (2) An example could be someone having the ability to foresee the evil that will come from major political decisions, elections, world events, wars, etc… that others may not see as that big of a deal
      (3) Write down Matt. 16:3. It says "And in the morning, It will be foul weather to day: for the sky is red and lowring. O ye hypocrites, ye can discern the face of the sky; but can ye not discern the signs of the times?"
         (a) This is another example of this gift. Discernment about the times and seasons of the end. Understanding the "spirits" of the world and how they are signs of the coming end times
3. This gift can be obtained just like any other gift

a) Solomon asks for this gift of discerning of spirits and he gets it (1 Kings 3:9)
b) People who are older and have had their senses exercised obtain this gift (Hebrews 5:14)
(1) Typically, older people can be seen as pessimistic and they can sound as though everything is the end of the world. The truth is, they have had their senses exercised and they have seen enough to know the truth behind what can be seemingly insignificant circumstances, events, instances, etc…
c) When you spend time in the word of God long enough and you allow the word of God to sink deep into your heart, you can use it to discern, and maybe even obtain this gift (Heb. 4:12)
(1) For this same reason, if you have this gift, you must always run your "discernment" through the word of God

4. This gift does not guarantee 100% success of discerning in all situations
a) This can lead to people with this gift sounding "judgmental" or always pessimistic
(1) Especially when they get it wrong, people will make sure and point it out
b) The only thing to do is continue to use your gift and try the spirits the best you can. Time will prove all things
5. Biblical examples of people with this gift
a) Jesus- Matt. 15:7-9; Luke 9:46-50
b) Paul- Acts 16:16-18

B. Helps

1. Those with this gift are supernaturally able to see and meet the needs of others (oftentimes even before they know they have a need), and to do it with great quietness and ease.
2. The heart of those with this gift
a) Prov. 3:27; Gal. 6:10
3. People with this gift go out of their way to help others
a) Duet. 22:4
(1) This may seem like the simple and obvious choice in this situation, but many people see similar situations all the time and either choose not to help, or they simply aren't paying attention and they miss it. PEOPLE WITH THIS GIFT DO NOT MISS THESE OPPORTUNITIES LIKE MOST WOULD. They easily see and act on these chances to help
4. Ways that people with this gift demonstrate help (these are just a few examples):
a) Prayer (2 Cor. 1:11)

b) Providing meals, car rides, clothes, cleaning, helping someone move, helping someone who is going through a loss, etc…. (innumerable ways)
c) Being a fatherly/motherly/brotherly/sisterly figure in someones life
d) Using a trade/talent you have to help someone in need
e) Providing good biblical advice to someone going through a tough time
f) Etc….

5. Biblical examples of people with this gift
   a) Moses- Exodus 2:16-19
   b) Aquila and Priscilla- Romans 16:3
   c) Urbane- Romans 16:9
      (1) Most of you have probably never heard of Urbane, his name only shows up this one time in the Bible. The lesson here; ANYONE CAN BE A HELPER. He isn't mentioned much as being a huge part in the work of the Lord, being an evangelist, teacher, preacher, prophet, etc… it says he was a helper. Maybe he simply opened up his home to Paul at some point. We don't know. All we know is that it meant such a deal to Paul that he mentions it here
      (2) Helpers have an opportunity to bless others and have an impact on the work of the Lord in amazing and simple ways that others miss. Don't neglect this gift

C. Governments

1. People with this gift are able to put together creative, effective, organizational plans in an area(s) of ministry in the church that causes it to function well
2. While rulers are all about executing plans and achieving goals through leading people, this gift is for those who are good at organizing and creating and doing behind the scenes "administrative" things that help the work of the Lord to be done at the highest level possible.
   a) James 3:4 displays this relationship perfectly
      (1) While the driving force of the ship is the wind, without the "governer" to guide it, the ship will move, but maybe not in the direction desired. The governor has to make sure that everyone is doing there jobs and that all details are in place to move in the correct direction
      (2) Think of the ship captains in old movies and all the jobs of all the deckhands. This requires organizational skills and order to be able to move large ships
3. Those with this gift are organized people who are good at helping to establish order
   a) 1 Cor. 11:34; 14:40; 16:1; Col. 2:5

b) Notice who so many of these instructions and statements are written to. Corinth! They were an unorganized mess and their ministry suffered because of it.

4. God loves order and people with this gift have the special ability to help the ministry and pleasing the Lord by bringing order
   a) Num. 24:5
   b) SHOW PHOTO ON SLIDESHOW
5. People with this gift have leadership qualities, but are typically better at the "governing" part of things than the "enacting" of plans
   a) Aaron and Moses worked together in this way (Exodus 4:14-16; 7:1-2)
      (1) Moses had the ruler quality, while Aaron was more eloquent and able to help him in the wording of and planning of things behind the scenes
6. Biblical examples of people with this gift
   a) Jethro- Exodus 18:13-27 (READ IN BIBLES)
      (1) Moses had the heart to do this for the Lord no matter how hard. His father however (probably where Aaron his brother got this from) was able to help him organize this into a more manageable/reasonable plan without compromising the purpose of what he was doing
   b) Luke- Luke 1:1-4; Acts 1:1
      (1) He was not there for the gospels, but did his due diligence to learn of all the things that Jesus did and write the record of it. This has now helped millions throughout the centuries to learn of the life of Christ
   c) Titus- Titus 1:5
      (1) Paul knew the personality of and gifts of Titus and he knew/trusted that he would set things in order in Crete. Titus was likely known for having orderliness and having this gift.

III. Any of us that feel that we have any of these gifts is responsible to use them. We cannot neglect the gifts God has entrusted us with. The body of Christ will **suffer** if you choose to neglect your gift, no matter what it is. If you don't have these, but desire to develop them, pray and ask God to help you with that. If you have these gifts and you are not using them to the extent that you need to be, search the word of God about your gift and do everything that God is calling you to do with your gift in order to bring glory to God!



Wednesday, June 15th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- 1 Cor. 12:8-10,28

I. Today, we will look at the final two spiritual gifts in our series and then the most important aspect surrounding all spiritual gifts. Understanding today's message is key in _____ using our gifts in order to function at full capacity as the body of Christ and to bring glory to God in our lives and ministries.

II. 1 Cor. 12:8-10,28

A. _____

1. Those with this gift are supernaturally gifted to see God's way by faith more than others or at times when others will not or cannot, and then communicate that faith confidently to edify the body of Christ
2. People with this gift are able to have faith in **what God says**. Others may "say" that they do as well, but people with this gift can more easily show their faith in their actions
    a) Heb. 11:7-10
3. People with this gift can more easily display faith even in situations where faith completely defies common sense
    a) Dan. 3:16-18; Matt. 14:28-29; Joshua 6 (the conquest at Jericho)
4. Someone with this gift has the ability to cause and see amazing things to happen
    a) Matt. 17:20; 21:21; Matt. 15:28; 9:2,22; Mark 2:5; 5:34; Luke 8:48
5. Biblical examples
    a) Everyone in the "Hall of Faith" in Hebrews 11
    b) Abraham- Rom. 4:20-21; Heb 11:8-10, 17-19
6. Faithful Gentile Centurion
    a) Matt. 8:5-13; Luke 7:1-10

B. _____

1. A person with this spiritual gift has the supernatural ability to understand and declare the prophesies of God in a meaningful way (edifying) to others. They will declare specific insightful things to all regarding the future that they glean from the words of God.
2. Prophesying in the bible is simply this: declaring unknown things or things that are yet to come as God reveals it to you through his words.
    a) In the OT, we called a person a prophet who
        (1) Heard the words of God concerning future events
        (2) Foretold of those events to others

3. The official office of “prophet” is clearly shown to have ended with John the Baptist (Matt. 11:13; Luke 16:16)
4. There are boundaries for prophesying today that were not in place during the OT. This is because we have “that which is perfect” and the “more sure word” today
    a) 2 Pet. 1:16-19; Rev. 22:19; 1 Cor. 13:8-10
5. People with this gift can really draw peoples interest in the Bible
6. Prophesying needs to result in edification
    a) 1 Cor. 14:-3-4, 23-25; Acts 15:32
7. Biblical examples of those with this gift
    a) John the Baptist (John 1:29 **with** Gen. 22:8; Exo. 12:3-13; Isa. 53:5-7)
    b) Jeremiah (Jer. 1:7)

C. **The More Excellent Way**- _____ (1 Cor. 12:31-13:1)

1. Charity is not a gift but something that we are all called to do. We are all supernaturally enabled to do this through the spirit of God, as God has shown us the most excellent display of charity that this universe has ever seen!
2. Biblical charity is an unconditional and sacrificial love shown through action (vs 4-7)
3. We can have all the gifts we want, but without charity none of it will matter (vs 1-2)
    a) Successful biblical ministries show charity (they are willing to sacrifice and put words into action) (Rev. 3:7-22)
        (1) The church in Philadelphia “brotherly love” was successful
        (2) The church in Laodicea “the rights of the people” was a failure
4. Gifts can/will fail but having charity will never fail (vs. 8-10)
5. God connects having charity and mixing it with these gifts, to maturing and growing up (vs 11)
6. God connects having a close relationship with him and having an intimate closeness to him, to charity (vs 12)
7. God considers charity to be the greatest quality to have (vs 13)
8. How do we get charity?
    a) Since charity is all about choice and not feelings, we need to make choices that are selfless and sacrificial (it costs us something))
        (1) Use all the gifts God has given you and do the work of the Lord especially when you don’t feel like it
        (2) Do things that you don’t want to do, that make you uncomfortable, that you “don’t have time” to do, etc… When you start obeying the Lord in this, you are showing charity
        (3) Grow closer in your walk with the Lord through the word and prayer

III. As we close out our series on Spiritual Gifts there is no better way to sum it up than the way the word of God does. “But covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way.” Desire spiritual gifts and use the gifts you are given, but never forget the more excellent way is charity. A heart of genuine love and sacrifice will _____ fail in your work for the Lord. This comes, like many things, only through a close personal walk with the Lord. There is no way around it: he is the one who gives us the gifts and enables us to do the work we do. We cannot do it

without him. If we are going to bring glory to God and have fruitful lives and ministries, we cannot do it without him or without one other as his body.



Wednesday, June 15th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- 1 Cor. 12:8-10,28

I. Today, we will look at the final two spiritual gifts in our series and then the most important aspect surrounding all spiritual gifts. Understanding today's message is key in **successfully** using our gifts in order to function at full capacity as the body of Christ and to bring glory to God in our lives and ministries.

II. 1 Cor. 12:8-10,28

A. Faith

1. Those with this gift are supernaturally gifted to see God's way by faith more than others or at times when others will not or cannot, and then communicate that faith confidently to edify the body of Christ
2. People with this gift are able to have faith in **what God says**. Others may "say" that they do as well, but people with this gift can more easily show their faith in their actions
    a) Heb. 11:7-10
3. People with this gift can more easily display faith even in situations where faith completely defies common sense
    a) Dan. 3:16-18; Matt. 14:28-29; Joshua 6 (the conquest at Jericho)
        (1) In all of these stories faith was without common sense. People with this gift are able to have and act upon faith in these impossible situations.
        (2) In the story in Joshua, we also see that this faith is shown consistently and with persistence. People with this gift completely lean upon faith in God no matter the amount of time that passes.
4. Someone with this gift has the ability to cause and see amazing things to happen
    a) Matt. 17:20; 21:21; Matt. 15:28; 9:2,22; Mark 2:5; 5:34; Luke 8:48
        (1) Almost always, faith is what precedes amazing miracles!
5. Biblical examples
    a) Everyone in the "Hall of Faith" in Hebrews 11
    b) Abraham- Rom. 4:20-21; Heb 11:8-10, 17-19
        (1) What was so great about the faith of Abraham? He was consistent and patient in his faith. We give up faith so easily many times in our lives. There were many promises made to Abraham and they all took a while to actually happen. He waited 25 years before his promised son was born and then he was told by God to offer this son up and without hesitation he did it having full faith in God. Consistency is key!
6. Faithful Gentile Centurion
    a) Matt. 8:5-13 (READ IN BIBLES); Luke 7:1-10

(1) Jesus says of this Gentile man who never met Jesus before, that he had not found so great faith in all Israel. What a statement!
(2) In Luke we see that this centurion had never met Jesus, only heard of Jesus. Yet without ever seeing a miracle (as many unbelieving Jews had) he had full faith that Jesus could not only heal his servant, but do it from a far distance (blessed are those who have not seen and yet believe)!

B. Prophesy

1. A person with this spiritual gift has the supernatural ability to understand and declare the prophesies of God in a meaningful way (edifying) to others. They will declare specific insightful things to all regarding the future that they glean from the words of God.
2. Prophesying in the bible is simply this: declaring unknown things or things that are yet to come as God reveals it to you through his words.
    a) With this in mind, we cannot overcomplicate what this means for us today. God has revealed specific truths about the future all over the bible. People with this gift have a special interest/gift in knowing and declaring these future events. They clearly understand many different future biblical prophesies that some other may know some or even nothing about.
    b) In the OT, we called a person a prophet who
        (1) Heard the words of God concerning future events
        (2) Foretold of those events to others
            (a) We can do the exact same today
3. The official office of "prophet" is clearly shown to have ended with John the Baptist (Matt. 11:13; Luke 16:16)
4. There are boundaries for prophesying today that were not in place during the OT. This is because we have "that which is perfect" and the "more sure word" today
    a) 2 Pet. 1:16-19; Rev. 22:19; 1 Cor. 13:8-10
        (1) The office of a prophet would have included "special" revelation from God, possibly outside of his words. Today it cannot and will not since it is a gift drawn from understanding the written prophesies and not an office where God gives you some "new" revelation
5. People with this gift can really draw people's interest in the Bible
    a) People love to hear about the end times, prophecies, tribulation, rapture, anti-christ and his kingdom, the kingdoms who will be around during the end, etc…. People with this gift have a good understanding of these things (you could say they specialize in this area) and this can be used for drawing peoples interest in the Bible
6. Prophesying needs to result in edification
    a) 1 Cor. 14:-3-4, 23-25; Acts 15:32
7. Biblical examples of those with this gift
    a) John the Baptist (GET READERS FOR EACH) (John 1:29 **with** Gen. 22:8; Exo. 12:3-13; Isa. 53:5-7)
        (1) John was known as the greatest prophet and was called such by Jesus himself (Luke 7:28) and yet he prophesied from the scripture!
    b) Jeremiah (Jer. 1:7)
        (1) Jeremiah is one of the major prophets in the OT. It has some of the most prophecy of any book! Yet, all that Jeremiah did was told of what God told

him. He heard from God and then foretold what God told him to the people

C. The More Excellent Way- Charity (1 Cor. 12:31-13:1) (OPEN TO IN BIBLES)

1. Charity is not a gift but something that we are all called to do. We are all supernaturally enabled to do this through the spirit of God, as God has shown us the most excellent display of charity that this universe has ever seen!
2. Biblical charity is an unconditional and sacrificial love shown through action (vs 4-7)
    a) We often relate "love" to a feeling. However, love in the bible is most closely associated with charity as it is an action or pattern of sacrificing unconditionally.
3. We can have all the gifts we want, but without charity none of it will matter (vs 1-2)
    a) Successful biblical ministries show charity (they are willing to sacrifice and put words into action) (Rev. 3:7-22)
        (1) The church in Philadelphia "brotherly love" was successful
        (2) The church in Laodicea "the rights of the people" was a failure
            (a) One church focused on love (unconditional sacrifice) and one focused on selfishness (their own rights and what they wanted)
            (b) The church in Corinth is another example of the selfish failing ministry; Paul was constantly telling them to stop worrying about what they can do/get away with and rather worry about what is BEST and able to reach the most people
4. Gifts can/will fail but having charity will never fail (vs. 8-10)
    a) You can have few gifts and even feel as though those gifts aren't very strong, but if you have true charity, you will glorify God in amazing ways!
5. God connects having charity and mixing it with these gifts, to maturing and growing up (vs 11)
6. God connects having a close relationship with him and having an intimate closeness to him, to charity (vs 12)
7. God considers charity to be the greatest quality to have (vs 13)
    a) When we have charity, we are ready to use our spiritual gifts; however, having spiritual gifts without charity means nothing. Charity is the greatest attribute any of us can possess. Without it, our spiritual gifts are useless.
8. How do we get charity?
    a) We all would say that we want to have this heart of charity so we can be useful for the Lord, however, it can be hard to have and it can be hard to know how to have it.
    b) Since charity is all about choice and not feelings, we need to make choices that are selfless and sacrificial (it costs us something))
        (1) Use all the gifts God has given you and do the work of the Lord especially when you don't feel like it.
            (a) It may feel odd at first but the Lord will change your heart when you commit your works to him. (Prov. 16:3)
        (2) Do things that you don't want to do, that make you uncomfortable, that you "don't have time" to do, etc… When you start obeying the Lord in this, you are showing charity.

(a) Think: if we only did the things that we felt love, excitement, joy, or happiness doing, then we wouldn't be sacrificing anything/as much (charity costs something)

(3) Grow closer in your walk with the Lord through the word and prayer

(i) Even when you feel like your not getting a great understanding of what you are reading and like you are "feeling" much, YOU ARE SPENDING TIME WITH GOD AND HE IS GOING TO WORK! It takes time! (charity suffereth long) It takes continued sacrifice!

(ii) There is no quick and easy path to just obtaining charity and to obtaining a close relationship with the Lord. Like other relationships it takes work, time, commitment, and it grows as you go along!

(a) READ THE WORD OF GOD WILL CHANGE YOUR HEART

(b) PRAYER WILL CHANGE YOUR HEART

(c) Our problem is that we usually give up way too soon and don't give it time. But God will change you through these things and you will grow closer to him. There is no replacement for a close and intimate walk with the Lord!

III. As we close out our series on Spiritual Gifts there is no better way to sum it up than the way the word of God does. "But covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way." Desire spiritual gifts and use the gifts you are given, but never forget the more excellent way is charity. A heart of genuine love and sacrifice will **never** fail in your work for the Lord. This comes, like many things, only through a close personal walk with the Lord. There is no way around it: he is the one who gives us the gifts and enables us to do the work we do. We cannot do it without him. If we are going to bring glory to God and have fruitful lives and ministries, we cannot do it without him or without one other as his body.